

• SALES & CONVERSION PLAYBOOK

From CFO Contact to Paying Customer

The exact scripts, sequences, and answers that turn a LinkedIn connection into a pilot, a pilot into a testimonial, and a testimonial into revenue.

For: Kuberan N · Founder, DataByt · US/EU mid-market B2B CFOs

Contents

1 · The Conversion Funnel	The path to revenue
2 · DM & Email Scripts	Opening the conversation
3 · The Discovery Call	Questions that close
4 · Objection Handling	Word-for-word answers
5 · Competitor Battle Card	DataByt vs the field
6 · The Free-Pilot Sequence	Pilot → testimonial → paid
7 · Asking for the Testimonial	The exact ask
8 · Converting Free to Paid	The money conversation

1 • The Conversion Funnel

Every stage has one job: move the CFO to the next step. Don't skip stages — a cold contact won't buy, but they will take a 15-minute call.

Stage	Goal	The tool
1 Connect	Become a familiar name	LinkedIn connect + note
2 Converse	Earn a reply, build rapport	No-pitch DM (\$2)
3 Call	Diagnose their AR pain	Discovery script (\$3)
4 Pilot	Get them using DataByt free	Free-pilot offer (\$6)
5 Prove	Deliver a visible win	The 2-week pilot plan (\$6)
6 Testimonial	Capture social proof	The testimonial ask (\$7)
7 Convert	Turn free into paid	The money conversation (\$8)

The golden rule: At this stage your goal is **learning + proof**, not revenue. Your first 5–10 pilots exist to give you testimonials, case studies, and product feedback. Money comes after proof. Don't rush stage 7.

Conversion math: ~Of 100 CFOs you connect with, expect ~40 accept, ~10 reply, ~4 take a call, ~2 start a pilot. To get 5 pilots, plan to connect with ~250 CFOs. The LinkedIn Playbook routine feeds this funnel.

2 · DM & Email Scripts

Never pitch in the first message. The goal of message one is a *reply*, not a sale.

A · The connection note (when sending the request)

LINKEDIN CONNECT NOTE

Hi [Name] — I'm building AI to fix B2B collections and I'm following finance leaders to learn what's actually broken in AR. Would love to connect and learn from your experience.

B · The opener (after they accept — wait 1 day)

FIRST DM — NO PITCH

Thanks for connecting, [Name]! Quick question since you lead finance at [Company] — what's the most frustrating part of chasing overdue invoices for your team right now? I'm building in this space and trying to learn from people who live it.

C · When they reply with a pain point

BUILD RAPPORT, THEN SOFT-OFFER

That's exactly what I keep hearing — [reflect their pain back in one line]. We built DataByt to automate precisely that: AI chases overdue invoices on a schedule, escalates the tone, and stops the moment someone pays.

I'm onboarding a few finance teams to use it free while we gather feedback. Worth a quick 15-min look at how it'd work on your AR? No pressure either way.

D · The "comment AR" follow-up (from a post)

WHEN SOMEONE COMMENTS "AR" ON YOUR DAY-20 POST

Thanks [Name]! Sent you a DM. Short version: I'll show you DataByt running on a sample of overdue invoices in ~15 min, and if it's useful, you can pilot it free. When works this week — Tue or Thu?

E · The cold email (if you have their address)

SUBJECT: QUICK Q ABOUT [COMPANY]'S DSO

Hi [Name],

I'll keep this short. Most finance teams at companies like [Company] are still chasing overdue invoices by hand — 10+ hours a week, inconsistent, and it quietly pushes DSO up.

DataByt automates it: AI sends the reminders, escalates tone by age, and stops when a customer pays. Live in 48 hours, connects to QuickBooks/Xero/NetSuite/Sage.

I'm letting a few teams pilot it free in exchange for feedback. Open to a 15-min look?

— Kuberan, Founder @ DataByt · databyt.in

Rule: One follow-up only if no reply (after ~4 days). Two unanswered messages = move on. Never triple-text a CFO.

3 • The Discovery Call

The best salespeople talk ~30% of the time. Your job on this call is to **diagnose**, not pitch. Let them describe the pain — then show the cure.

The 15-minute structure

- 1 Frame (1 min):** "Thanks for the time. I want to understand how your team handles collections today, and if DataByt's a fit, I'll show you exactly how it'd work. If it's not, I'll tell you straight."
- 2 Diagnose (7 min):** Ask the questions below. Listen. Take notes. Reflect their pain back.
- 3 Show (5 min):** Screen-share DataByt on sample data. Show their kind of pain getting solved (see the Demo Script doc).
- 4 Close to pilot (2 min):** "Want to try this on your real invoices, free, for two weeks?"

The discovery questions (ask these exactly)

- "Walk me through how your team chases an overdue invoice today — step by step."
- "Who actually does it, and how many hours a week does it eat?"
- "Do you know your DSO off the top of your head? Is it trending up or down?"
- "How much is sitting in overdue invoices right now, roughly?"
- "What have you tried before — agency, software, just hiring? What happened?"
- "If chasing invoices just... happened automatically, what would that free your team to do?"

The magic question is the last one. It makes them describe the value *in their own words* — which is far more persuasive than you pitching it.

Qualify, don't convince. A good fit: \$3M–\$100M B2B, 30+ overdue invoices, DSO they're unhappy with, doing it manually. A bad fit: tiny, no AR pain, or a Fortune 500 with HighRadius already. If they're not a fit, say so — your honesty becomes your reputation.

4 • Objection Handling

Objections aren't rejection — they're requests for reassurance. Answer calmly, briefly, then re-offer the pilot.

"How are you different from HighRadius / Billtrust?"

"They're enterprise tools — six-figure budgets, months to implement, a team to run them. DataByt is built for finance teams of 1–3 at mid-market companies. Live in 48 hours, no IT, a fraction of the cost. Same automation, none of the enterprise weight."

"Is my data safe?"

"Yes. Your data is isolated per organisation, encrypted, and we only read what's needed to chase invoices. We never share or sell data. You can export everything and delete your account anytime — no lock-in."

"Will this annoy my customers / hurt relationships?"

"That's exactly why we built tone escalation. Early reminders are warm and friendly — they assume the customer just forgot. It only gets firmer over time, and you can set strategic customers to extra-courteous. You stay in control, and you review anything before it's automated."

"Why should I trust an AI to email my customers?"

"You don't have to hand over the keys on day one. In the pilot, you approve emails before they send. Once you see the AI writes them as well as your team — better, actually, because it's consistent — you can let it run automatically. Your call, every step."

"We don't use QuickBooks or Xero."

"No problem — you can import a simple CSV from any system, and NetSuite and Sage are supported too. Takes minutes. We'll have your AR in DataByt either way."

"I don't have time to switch tools right now."

"That's the best reason to try it — it removes work, doesn't add it. Setup is 48 hours and we do it with you. The pilot is free and you can walk away anytime. The only thing it costs you is the 15 minutes we already spent."

"How much does it cost?"

"Right now I'm onboarding a small group free in exchange for feedback and a testimonial if you're happy. After that it's one flat plan, no per-seat fees — and a founding rate locked in for early customers. Let's prove it works on your AR first; pricing's the easy part."

5 • Competitor Battle Card

Know exactly where you win. Never bad-mouth competitors — position around the gap they leave.

Option	Their world	Where DataByt wins
HighRadius / Billtrust	Enterprise, 6-figure, months to deploy, needs a team	Built for mid-market 1–3 person finance teams. 48 hrs, no IT, fraction of the cost.
Tesorio / Upflow	Solid, but pricier & heavier for SMBs	Simpler, faster to value, AI takes actions (not just dashboards).
Collections agency	Takes 10–25% of recovered cash, can torch relationships	Flat cost, you keep 100%, tone protects the relationship.
Hiring an AR clerk	\$50–70K/yr, still manual, single point of failure	Automates the repetitive 80%; your team handles the human 20%.
QuickBooks/Xero reminders	Basic, same-tone, no escalation or strategy	AI escalation, segmentation, disputes, live CEI/DSO, batching.
Spreadsheet + memory	Free, but inconsistent & fragile	A system, not a person's memory. Consistent, automatic, tracked.

Your one-line positioning

"DataByt is the AR collections tool built for the mid-market companies the enterprise giants ignored — automated, affordable, live in 48 hours."

When a CFO names a competitor: "Great tool — for a different company. Here's who it's built for, and here's why DataByt fits a team your size better." Respect, then reframe.

6 • The Free-Pilot Sequence

The pilot is your most powerful sales tool. A CFO who sees DataByt recover real cash needs no convincing. Run it as a tight, time-boxed plan with a clear win.

The offer (how to frame it)

THE PILOT PITCH

"Here's what I'd suggest: let's run DataByt on your real AR, free, for two weeks. I'll set it up with you in 48 hours. You approve every email before it sends. At the end, you'll see exactly how much we moved — invoices chased, replies, payments. If it's not obviously useful, we part as friends and you keep all your data."

The 2-week pilot plan

Day	What happens
Day 0	Onboard: connect data (or CSV), set signature + payment link, set segments. (See Demo & Onboarding Script.)
Day 1–2	Review the AR aging together. Agree which overdue invoices to chase first.
Day 2–10	AI sends reminders (CFO approves first batch, then lets it run). Track opens, replies, payments.
Day 10–12	Handle any disputes; mark payments received. Watch DSO/overdue % move.
Day 14	The wrap-up call — show the results. This is where you ask for the testimonial and the paid conversation.

Engineer a visible win

- Pick 1–2 chaseable overdue invoices likely to pay during the window — an early payment is your proof.
- Track a clear before/after: "Day 0: \$X overdue, DSO Y. Day 14: \$Z collected, N reminders sent, M replies."
- Even if little is collected in 14 days, the *time saved* and *consistency* are the win. Quantify hours saved.

Always end the pilot with a scheduled wrap-up call. Never let a pilot just fizzle out. The Day-14 call is where pilots become customers.

7 • Asking for the Testimonial

A testimonial from a real CFO is worth more than any ad. Ask at the moment of maximum happiness — right after they see a result.

When to ask

On the Day-14 wrap-up call, immediately after showing a positive result, while they're nodding. Or the moment they say something like "this is great" — that's your cue.

The ask (make it easy)

THE TESTIMONIAL ASK

"I'm really glad it's working for you. Honestly, the best thing you could do for me right now isn't to pay — it's to let me share your experience. Would you be open to a short testimonial I can use? I can even draft it from what you've told me and you just edit or approve it. One line about what DataByt changed for your team would mean the world."

Make it frictionless — offer 3 formats

- **Easiest:** you draft 2–3 sentences from their own words, they approve → you post it.
- **Better:** a LinkedIn recommendation on your profile (huge for the algorithm + trust).
- **Best:** a 60-second video clip or a named quote with their title/company.

The draft-it-for-them template

DRAFT YOU SEND THEM TO APPROVE

"Before DataByt, our team spent hours every week chasing invoices by hand and our DSO kept creeping up. Within two weeks, [result — e.g. 'we'd automated all our reminders and recovered \$X']. It's like having an AR analyst that never forgets. — [Name], [Title], [Company]"

Why draft it yourself: A busy CFO will rarely write one from scratch — but they'll happily approve a good draft in 30 seconds. Remove every ounce of friction.

8 • Converting Free to Paid

Once you have proof and a few testimonials, the free era ends and the paid era begins. This is the money conversation — handle it with confidence, not apology.

When to have it

- After the pilot delivered a clear win, and they've given a testimonial
- Once you have ~3–5 happy pilots / testimonials in hand (proof gives you pricing confidence)
- At the natural end of the free period — frame it as graduation, not a bill

The conversion conversation

FREE → PAID

"You've seen what DataByt does on your real AR — [recap the result]. The free pilot was to prove it works, and it has. To keep it running, it's one flat plan, everything included, no per-seat fees. As one of our early customers, I'll lock in the founding rate for you — it won't go up as we grow. Shall I keep your account live and get you set up?"

Pricing principles for this stage

Principle	Why
Flat plan, no per-seat	Simple to say yes to; no math, no procurement friction
Founding rate, locked	Rewards early believers; creates urgency to commit now
Anchor to value, not cost	"It recovers \$X and saves Y hours" >> "it costs \$Z"
Annual option	Better cash for you; offer a discount vs monthly

Don't undercharge out of fear. If DataByt frees \$400K in cash and saves 10 hours/week, a few hundred a month is trivial. Price to the value you deliver, not to your nerves. Your testimonials give you the confidence to hold the number.

If they hesitate on price

THE REFRAME

"Totally fair. Let's look at it differently: in the pilot we [recovered \$X / saved Y hours]. The plan costs less than [a fraction of that value / one hour of your AR person's time per week]. The question isn't really the price — it's whether you want to keep that result running. I think you do."

THE WHOLE PLAYBOOK IN ONE LINE

**Connect without pitching. Diagnose without selling. Prove with a free pilot.
Then charge with confidence — because the proof does the closing for you.**